“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 1

The Pastimes of Śrī Caitanya

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 May the Lord Śrī Caitanyadeva be fully gracious to me — He by whose grace even an ignorant person at once becomes all-knowing.

2 I worship Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda, who have risen together like the sun and the moon on the eastern horizon of Gauḍa. Wondrous and bestowing auspiciousness, They dispel the darkness.

3 All glory to the most merciful Rādhā and Madana-mohana! They are the refuge of me, who am lame and of little intelligence, and Their lotus feet are my all in all.

4 In resplendent Vṛndāvana, beneath a wish-fulfilling tree, Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Śrīla Govinda-deva sit on a throne in a splendid jewelled temple, and Their dearest companions serve Them. I remember Them.

5 Beautiful Śrī Gopīnātha began the sweet *rasa* of the rāsa dance. He stands on the riverbank at Vaṁśīvaṭa and draws the gopīs with the sound of His flute. May He bestow His blessings upon us.

6 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to the ocean of mercy! Glory, glory to the son of Śacī! Glory to the friend of the fallen!

7 Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory, glory to all the devotees of Gaura, headed by Śrīvāsa!

8 Earlier I told the *sūtras* (brief threads) of the Ādi-līlā, which Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in full.

9 Therefore I gave only the sūtras of it; whatever particulars there were, I told within the sūtras themselves.

10 Now I shall tell the main sūtras of the final pastimes (Śeṣa-līlā). The Lord's pastimes are endless; they cannot be fully described.

11 Of these, the portion that Vṛndāvana dāsa described in detail in his *Caitanya-maṅgala* —

12 — of that portion I shall write here only the sūtras; whatever particulars remain unsaid there, I shall expand here.

13 Vṛndāvana dāsa is the Vyāsa of Caitanya's pastimes. By his order I am only chewing his remnants.

14 With devotion I hold his feet upon my head, and now I describe the sūtras of the final pastimes.

15 For twenty-four years the Lord lived at home; the pastimes He performed there are called the Ādi-līlā.

16 At the close of His twenty-fourth year, in the bright fortnight of the month of Māgha, the Lord accepted *sannyāsa*.

17 After taking sannyāsa He remained for twenty-four years; the pastimes of that time are called the Śeṣa-līlā.

18 The Śeṣa-līlā has two names, ‘Madhya’ (middle) and ‘Anta’ (final): all Vaiṣṇavas name its parts differently according to the difference in the pastimes.

19 Of these, six years were spent going and coming between Nīlācala, Gauḍa, Setubandha and Vṛndāvana.

20 The pastimes of that period are called the Madhya-līlā; the pastimes after it are named the Antya-līlā.

21 Thus there are the Ādi-līlā, the Madhya-līlā and the Antya-līlā. Now I shall expand somewhat on the Madhya-līlā.

22 For eighteen years He stayed only at Nīlācala. Practising devotion Himself, He taught it to the living beings.

23 Of these, for six years, in the company of His devotees, He established loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*) in the joy of dancing and singing.

24 He sent Nityānanda Gosāñi to the land of Gauḍa, and Nityānanda flooded Gauḍa with the nectar of love.

25 Nityānanda is by nature unrestrained in love for Kṛṣṇa, and by the Lord’s order He gave that love away everywhere.

26 Millions of obeisances at His feet! He who is dear to Caitanya made the whole world accept Him.

27 He whom Caitanya Gosāñi calls His ‘elder brother’ says, ‘My Lord is Caitanya Gosāñi.’

28 Although He Himself is Lord Balarāma, He still regards Himself as Caitanya’s servant.

29 “Serve Caitanya! Sing of Caitanya! Take Caitanya’s name! Whoever is devoted to Caitanya is My very life.”

30 In this way He made people take up devotion to Caitanya and delivered everyone — the wretched, the lowly and even blasphemers.

31 Then the Lord sent Rūpa and Sanātana to Vraja, and by His order the two brothers came to Vṛndāvana.

32 Preaching devotion, they revealed all the holy places and spread the service of Madana-gopāla and Govinda.

33 Gathering many scriptures, they composed books of devotion that are their essence, and so delivered foolish and fallen people.

34 By the Lord’s order they examined all the scriptures and preached the confidential devotion of Vraja.

35 *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, *Bhāgavatāmṛta*, *Daśama-ṭippanī* and *Daśama-carita* —

36 all these books Sanātana Gosāñi composed. And who can count all that Rūpa Gosāñi composed?

37 I shall name some of the principal ones. In a hundred thousand verses he described the pastimes of Vraja.

38 *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, *Vidagdha-mādhava*, *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* and *Lalita-mādhava*;

39 *Dāna-keli-kaumudī*, many hymns (*Stavāvalī*), the eighteen *Līlā-cchandas* and *Padyāvalī*;

40 *Govinda-virudāvalī* with its *lakṣaṇa* (definitions), *Mathurā-māhātmya* and *Nāṭaka-varṇana*.

41 Who can count *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* and the rest? Everywhere in them he described the pastimes of Vraja.

42 His nephew is named Śrī Jīva Gosāñi. There is no end to the books of devotion he composed.

43 In his extensive book named *Śrī Bhāgavata-sandarbha* he has written the essence of the conclusions of devotion.

44 The mighty book named *Gopāla-campū* establishes the eternal pastimes and is full of the *rasa* of Vraja.

45 In this way they brought out many books and lived in Vṛndāvana together with their community.

46 In the first year the devotees headed by Advaita went to Nīlādri to see the Lord.

47 Having seen the Ratha-yātrā, they stayed there four months, dancing and singing with the Lord in supreme joy.

48 When they took leave, the Lord told them all, “Come every year, all of you, to see the Guṇḍicā festival.”

49 By the Lord’s order the devotees came every year, saw the Guṇḍicā festival, met the Lord and went back.

50 For twelve years they came and went like this; neither the Lord nor His devotees could live without each other.

51 In the twelve years that remained at the end, the Lord's heart was filled with the pastimes of separation from Kṛṣṇa.

52 Night and day, in the divine madness of separation, He laughed, wept, danced and sang in great sorrow.

53 Whenever He took *darśana* of Jagannātha, He thought, "I have found Him again at Kurukṣetra."

54 When He danced in front of the Ratha-yātrā, He sang only this song:

55 "I have found that very Lord of My life for whom I was wasting away, burning in the fire of Madana (love)."

56 To this refrain He danced through the second *prahara* (watch) of the day, feeling within, "Taking Kṛṣṇa, I go back to Vraja."

57 In this mood, in the midst of the dance, He recited a verse whose meaning none of the people understood:

58 "He who stole My heart in My girlhood is the same beloved; these are the same moonlit nights of Caitra, the same full breezes from the kadamba trees, fragrant with blossoming *mālatī*; and I am the same girl. Yet My heart yearns for those pastimes of love there, beneath the *vetasī* tree on the bank of the Revā." (Padyāvalī 386)

59 Svarūpa alone knew the meaning of this verse. By providence, that year Rūpa had come there.

60 Hearing the verse from the Lord's mouth, Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi then and there composed a verse giving its meaning.

61 Having composed the verse and written it on a palm leaf, he tucked it into the thatched roof of his dwelling.

62 Leaving the verse there, he went to bathe in the sea, and at that very time the Lord came to meet him.

63 Haridāsa Ṭhākura, Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana — these three did not go into the temple of Jagannātha.

64 After seeing Jagannātha's *upala-bhoga* offering, Mahāprabhu would meet these three and then go to His own residence.

65 Whichever of the three was there at the time, the Lord would come and meet him Himself — this was His rule.

66 When the Lord came and by chance looked up, He found that verse on the palm leaf tucked into the thatch.

67 Having read the verse, the Lord stood absorbed in ecstasy. Rūpa Gosāñi came and fell before Him flat like a rod.

68 Mahāprabhu got up, gave him a slap, took him in His arms and said:

69 "No one knows the intent of My verse. How did you know what was in My mind?"

70 Saying this, He showed him great favour, and then took the verse and showed it to Svarūpa Gosāñi.

71 Astonished, the Lord asked Svarūpa, "How did Rūpa know what is in My mind?"

72 Svarūpa said, “Since he knew Your mind, I know from this that he has received Your mercy.”

73 The Lord said, “Pleased with him, I embraced him and infused all potencies into him.

74 He is a worthy recipient for discerning the confidential *rasa*. You too should speak to him and explain that confidential *rasa*.”

75 All this I shall tell later in detail; here, finding the occasion, I have mentioned it briefly.

76 “My dear companion, this is that same beloved Kṛṣṇa, met again at Kurukṣetra, and I am that same Rādhā; this is the same joy of Our union. Yet My heart longs for the forest on the bank of the Kālindī, which delights in the sweet fifth note of His flute playing in its depths.” (Padyāvalī 387)

77 Hear, O devotees, the brief meaning of this verse — how the Lord felt on seeing Jagannātha.

78 Although Śrī Rādhikā obtains the sight of Kṛṣṇa at Kurukṣetra, She still thinks:

79 “Royal dress, elephants, horses and crowds of people! Where is His cowherd dress, where is secluded Vṛndāvana?

80 Only when I regain that mood, that Kṛṣṇa and that Vṛndāvana will My desire be fulfilled.”

81 And they said: “O Lord whose navel is like a lotus, the masters of yoga, whose wisdom is fathomless, meditate on Your lotus feet within their hearts; those feet are the support that rescues those fallen into the well of

worldly life. May they always rise in our minds too, though we are attached to our homes." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.82.48)

82 "If Your feet rise in My home in the village of Vraja, then My desire will be fulfilled."

83 Having considered the meaning of this verse of the *Bhāgavata*, Rūpa Gosāñi composed a verse that explains it to people.

84 "The blessed land of Mathurā shines, encircled by its charms and by forests that exhale the fragrance of the nectar of Your pastimes. There, surrounded by us, whose hearts are enchanted by the mood of playful cowherd girls, enjoy Your pastimes with the flute shining at Your lips." (Lalita-mādhava 10.38)

85 Thus, when Mahāprabhu looked at Jagannātha, He saw Him with Subhadrā and with no flute in His hand.

86 "Where in Vraja shall I find the son of the king of Vraja, beautiful in His threefold bending?" — this was His constant desire.

87 Just as Rādhikā fell into divine madness on seeing Uddhava, so the Lord, night and day, spoke in the bewildered raving (*udghūrṇā*) of that madness.

88 Thus He passed the last twelve years. In this way I have set out the arrangement of the final pastimes.

89 Whatever He did during the twenty-four years after taking sannyāsa is endless and boundless — who can know its inner meaning?

90 Just to give a pointer, I offer a glimpse and list the sūtras of the principal pastimes.

91 The first sūtra is the Lord's acceptance of sannyāsa. Having taken sannyāsa, the Lord set out for Śrī Vṛndāvana.

92 Overwhelmed by love, with no awareness of the outer world, He wandered for three days in Rāḍha-deśa.

93 Nityānanda Prabhu beguiled Mahāprabhu and led Him to the bank of the Gaṅgā, calling it the Yamunā.

94 He came to the Ācārya's house in Śāntipura; there He took His first *bhikṣā* (meal as a sannyāsī), and at night there was saṅkīrtana.

95 There He met His mother and the devotees, and having settled everything, He left for Nīlādri.

96 On the way there were many pastimes: *darśana* of all the Deities, the story of Mādhava Purī and the installation of Gopāla,

97 the story of the theft of sweet rice and the account of Sākṣi-gopāla. And Nityānanda broke the Lord's staff.

98 Angered, He went alone to see Jagannātha; on seeing Him, He fell unconscious to the ground.

99 Sārvabhauma took Him to his own house, and in the third *prahara* of the day the Lord regained consciousness.

100 Nityānanda, Jagadānanda, Dāmodara and Mukunda came afterwards, met Him, and all rejoiced.

101 Then the Lord showed mercy to Sārvabhauma and revealed to him His own form as the Lord.

102 Then the Lord set out for the South. At Kūrma-kṣetra He delivered Vāsudeva.

103 At Jiyaḍa-nṛsiṁha He offered prayers to Nṛsiṁha, and on every road and in every village He established the chanting of the holy name.

104 In the forest on the bank of the Godāvarī He mistook the place for Vṛndāvana, and right there He met Rāmānanda Rāya.

105 He visited the holy places of Trimalla and Tripadī, and everywhere He spread the name of Kṛṣṇa.

106 Then He subdued the atheists, and He had *darśana* of Ahovala-nṛsiṁha and other Deities.

107 He came to Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra on the bank of the Kāverī, and on seeing Śrī Raṅga He was overwhelmed with love.

108 The Lord lived in the house of Trimalla Bhaṭṭa and stayed there for the four months of the rains.

109 Trimalla Bhaṭṭa, a Śrī-vaiṣṇava, was a great scholar, and he was astonished at the Gosāñi's learning and love.

110 Mahāprabhu passed the *Cāturmāsya* with the Śrī-vaiṣṇavas in dancing, singing and the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name.

111 After the Cāturmāsya He again went south, and there He met Paramānanda Purī.

112 Then came the rescue of Kṛṣṇadāsa from the Bhaṭṭathāris, and the spreading of Kṛṣṇa's name through the mouths of brahmins who chanted Rāma's name.

113 There He met Śrī Raṅga Purī, and He relieved the sorrow of the brahmin Rāmadāsa.

114 He discussed the truth with the Tattvavādīs, and they all came to regard themselves as inferior.

115 He had *darśana* of Ananta, Puruṣottama, Śrī Janārdana, Padmanābha and Vāsudeva.

116 Then the Lord liberated the seven palm trees (Sapta-tāla), bathed at Setubandha and had *darśana* of Rāmeśvara.

117 There He heard the *Kūrma Purāṇa*, in which it is written that Rāvaṇa carried off an illusory Sītā (*māyā-sītā*).

118 Hearing this, the Lord was delighted at heart, and He remembered the words of the brahmin Rāmadāsa.

119 He eagerly took that ancient leaf, showed it to Rāmadāsa and dispelled his sorrow.

120 He found two manuscripts, the *Brahma-saṁhitā* and the *Karṇāmṛta*, and knowing them to be excellent, He brought the two books back with Him.

121 Once again He went back to Nīlācala; meeting the devotees, He saw the Snāna-yātrā (the bathing festival).

122 During *anavasara*, unable to see Jagannātha, He went to Ālālanātha in the pain of separation.

123 He stayed there a few days with the devotees, and then received news that the devotees of Gauḍa were coming.

124 Nityānanda and Sārvabhauma pressed Him and brought Mahāprabhu back to Nīlācala.

125 The Lord passed His nights and days overwhelmed by separation. At that time the devotees of Gauḍa arrived.

126 They all gathered, took counsel and began *kīrtana*; absorbed in the kīrtana, the Lord's mind grew calm.

127 Earlier, when the Lord met Rāmānanda, He had ordered him to come to Nīlācala.

128 Taking the king's permission, he came some days later, and night and day the Lord talked about Kṛṣṇa with Rāmānanda.

129 He showed mercy to Kāśī Miśra and met Pradyumna Miśra and others; Paramānanda Purī, Govinda and Kāśīśvara arrived.

130 Meeting Svarūpa Dāmodara brought Him supreme joy; He also met Śikhi Māhiti and Bhavānanda Rāya.

131 All the Vaiṣṇavas came from Gauḍa, and there was the first meeting with the residents of Kulīna-grāma.

132 All the residents of Khaṇḍa, headed by Narahari Dāsa, came with Śivānanda Sena and met the Lord.

133 After seeing the Snāna-yātrā with the devotees, the Lord took them all and cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple.

134 With everyone He saw the Ratha-yātrā; He danced before the chariot and then went to a garden.

135 In that place He showed mercy to Pratāparudra. On the day of farewell He gave the devotees of Gauḍa an order:

136 “Come every year to see the Ratha-yātrā.” On this pretext He wished to meet His devotees.

137 Then there was the splendid meal for the Lord at Sārvabhauma’s house, because of which Ṣāṭhī’s mother said, “Let Ṣāṭhī become a widow!”

138 The next year the devotees headed by Advaita came again: they all set out to see the Lord.

139 Joyfully he led them all and gave them lodging — Śivānanda Sena looked after everyone.

140 A fortunate dog came with Śivānanda; having seen the Lord’s feet, it vanished from this world.

141 On the way they all met Sārvabhauma, and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya went on to Kāśī.

142 All the Vaiṣṇavas came and met the Lord, and the Lord sported in the water with them all.

143 Taking everyone, He cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple, and at the Ratha-yātrā the Lord danced.

144 In the gardens the Lord enjoyed various pastimes, and the brāhmaṇa Kṛṣṇadāsa performed His ceremonial bath (*abhiṣeka*).

145 At Guṇḍicā, after dancing, He played in the water, and on Herā-pañcamī He watched the pastime of the goddess Lakṣmī.

146 At the festival of Kṛṣṇa's birth the Lord dressed as a cowherd; He carried a yoke laden with pots of yogurt and then twirled a staff.

147 Then He bade farewell to the devotees of Gauḍa, and with the devotees who stayed with Him He held *kīrtana* constantly.

148 Intending to go to Vṛndāvana, He set out for Gauḍa, and on the way Pratāparudra served Him in many ways.

149 Then came the episode of the gift of cloth with Purī Gosāñi, and Rāmānanda Rāya accompanied Him as far as Bhadraka.

150 Arriving in Bengal, He stayed in the house of Vidyā-vācaspati, and crowds of people gathered to see Him.

151 For five days people kept coming to see Him without pause; to escape the crowds, the Lord went at night to the village of Kuliyā.

152 Hearing that the Lord had come to Kuliyā, millions upon millions of people came to see Him.

153 In Kuliyā He showed His grace to Devānanda and forgave the brāhmaṇa Gopāla his offense against Śrīvāsa.

154 Heretics and blasphemers came and fell at His feet; He forgave their offenses and gave them love for Kṛṣṇa.

155 When Nṛsiṁhānanda heard that the Lord would go to Vṛndāvana, he joyfully decorated the road in his mind.

156 From the town of Kuliyā he paved the road with jewels and spread over it a bed of flowers with their stems removed.

157 On both sides of the road stood rows of flowering *bakula* trees, and here and there on either side lay divine ponds,

158 with bathing steps built of jewels and full-blown lotuses, the chatter of many birds and water like nectar.

159 A cool breeze blew, bearing many fragrances. Thus he paved the road as far as Kānāi's Nāṭaśālā.

160 Beyond that his mind would not go; he could not pave any further. The road could not be paved, and Nṛsiṁhānanda was astonished.

161 “I tell you with certainty — listen, O devotees: this time the Lord will not go to Śrī Vṛndāvana.

162 He will turn back from Kānāi's Nāṭaśālā. You will see it later; I have said this with certainty.”

163 The Lord set out from Kuliyā for Vṛndāvana, and thousands of people went with Him, all of them devotees.

164 Wherever the Lord went, people came by the millions to see Him, and seeing Him, they were freed from sorrow and grief.

165 Wherever the Lord's feet touched the ground as He walked, people took away that earth, leaving pits in the road.

166 Walking on in this way, the Lord came to the village of Rāmakeli, a village of incomparable beauty near Gauḍa.

167 There the Lord danced, losing outer consciousness in love, and millions upon millions of people came to see His feet.

168 Hearing of His power, the Muslim king who ruled Gauḍa was amazed and said:

169 “One whom so many people follow without being given anything is surely a holy master (*gosāñi*). Know this for certain.

170 Qāzī, Muslims — let no one harm Him. Let Him wander wherever He pleases.”

171 The king asked Keśava Chatrī for news of Him, but Chatrī brushed aside the Lord's greatness:

172 “He is a mendicant *sannyāsī* touring the holy places. Only a handful of people come to see Him.

173 Some Muslim has been slandering Him to you. You gain nothing by harming Him; rather, you would suffer loss.”

174 Having pacified the king, Keśava sent a brāhmaṇa, who went and asked the Lord to leave.

175 Then the king questioned Dabira Khāsa in private, and he began to tell of the Lord's greatness:

176 “He who gave you your kingdom, He who is your Lord, has come and taken birth in your country by your good fortune.

177 He desires your welfare, and His words come true; by His blessing you will be victorious everywhere.

178 Why do you ask me? Ask your own heart. As a ruler of men you are like a part of Viṣṇu.

179 Whatever understanding of Caitanya arises in your heart — whatever your heart accepts — that is the proof."

180 The king said: "Listen to what my heart accepts: He is God Himself. Of this there is no doubt."

181 Saying this, the king withdrew to his inner apartments, and Dabira Khāsa returned to his own house.

182 At home the two brothers took counsel together and went in disguise to see the Lord.

183 At midnight the two brothers came to where the Lord was staying. First they met Nityānanda and Haridāsa,

184 and these two informed the Lord: "Rūpa and Sākara-mallika have come to see You."

185 Holding bunches of straw between their teeth and with cloths tied around their necks, the two brothers fell flat like rods.

186 They wept in humility, overwhelmed with joy. The Lord said, "Rise, rise! Good fortune has come."

187 Rising, the two brothers, still holding straw between their teeth, humbly offered prayers with joined palms:

188 "Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the merciful! Glory to the savior of the fallen! Glory to the magnanimous Lord!

189 We are low-born, we keep low company and do low work; O Lord, we are ashamed even to speak before You.

190 “There is no sinner like me, nor any offender like me. O Puruṣottama, I am ashamed even to ask forgiveness; what more can I say?” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 1.2.154)

191 You descended to deliver the fallen, and in all the world there are none more fallen than we.

192 You delivered the two brothers Jagāi and Mādhāi, but delivering them cost You no effort.

193 They were brāhmaṇas by birth and lived in Navadvīpa. They did not serve low people, nor were they the low people's “elbow” (their instruments).

194 Their only fault was sinful conduct, and even the semblance of Your name (*nāmābhāsa*) burns up heaps of sin.

195 They uttered Your name while blaspheming You, and that very name became the cause of their liberation.

196 We two are millions of times lower, more fallen and more sinful than Jagāi and Mādhāi.

197 We are *mlecchas* by birth, keep the company of *mlecchas* and do the deeds of *mlecchas*; we associate with the enemies of cows and brāhmaṇas.

198 My own deeds have bound me by the hands and neck and thrown me into the pit of filth that is wicked sense enjoyment.

199 No one in the three worlds is strong enough to deliver us — none but You, the savior of the fallen.

200 If You show Your strength by delivering us, then Your name “Savior of the Fallen” will be fulfilled.

201 I tell You one true thing — listen, O merciful Lord: in all the world there is no one so fit for mercy as I.

202 Show me mercy and make Your name “Merciful” (or: Your own mercy) bear fruit; let the whole universe see the power of Your mercy.

203 “Hear one petition I lay before You; it is no lie but the highest truth: if You will not show me mercy, O Lord, You will hardly find anyone more fit for Your mercy.” (Stotra-ratna 47)

204 Seeing my own unworthiness, I am distressed at heart; yet Your qualities awaken longing in me.

205 As a dwarf wishes to catch the moon, so this desire rises in my heart.

206 “When, O Lord, serving You alone without cease, with every other desire completely stilled, shall I live as Your wholly devoted eternal servant and fill my life with joy?” (Stotra-ratna 43)

207 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu said: “Listen, Dabira Khāsa: you two brothers are My servants of old.

208 From today your names are Rūpa and Sanātana. Give up this humility — your humility breaks My heart.

209 Time and again you wrote Me humble letters, and through those letters I came to know your life.

210 Through those letters I knew your hearts, and to instruct you I quoted a verse again and again:

211 “A woman attached to a man other than her husband may seem busy with her household duties, but within she relishes only the nectar of new meetings with him.”

212 I had no reason to come near Gauḍa; I came here only to see you two.

213 No one knows this, the secret of My heart; everyone asks why I have come to Rāmakeli.

214 It is good that you two brothers came to Me. Now go home and do not be afraid.

215 Birth after birth you two are My servants. Very soon Kṛṣṇa will deliver you.”

216 Saying this, He placed His two hands on their heads, and the two brothers took the Lord's feet and placed them on their heads.

217 Embracing them both, the Lord said to the devotees: “All of you, be merciful and deliver these two.”

218 Seeing the Lord's mercy on the two, all the devotees joyfully called out, “Hari! Hari!”

219 Nityānanda, Haridāsa, Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara, Mukunda, Jagadānanda, Murāri and Vakreśvara were there.

220 The two brothers clasped the feet of each of them and fell down, and all said: “You are blessed — you have attained the Lord.”

221 Asking leave of everyone, at the time of departure they humbly spoke to the Lord at His feet:

222 “Leave this place, O Lord; there is nothing for You here. Although the king of Gauḍa shows You devotion,

223 he is still a Muslim by birth — do not trust him. And such a crowd is not the proper way to go on pilgrimage.

224 To go to Vṛndāvana with hundreds of thousands of people following is not the proper manner.”

225 Although in truth the Lord has nothing to fear, still His pastime here is human-like and full of ordinary human conduct.

226 Saying this, the two saluted His feet and left, and the Lord resolved to leave that village.

227 Setting out in the morning, the Lord came to Kānāi's Nāṭaśālā, and there He saw depicted all the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa.

228 That night the Lord pondered within Himself: “Sanātana says it is not good to travel with a crowd.

229 If I go to Mathurā with so many people, there will be no happiness in it; the *rasa* will be spoiled.

230 I shall go alone, or with just one companion; only then will the journey to Vṛndāvana be graceful.”

231 Thinking this, Gaurahari bathed in the Gaṅgā in the morning and set out, saying, “I shall go to Nīlācala.”

232 Walking on in this way He came to Śāntipura and stayed five or seven days at the Ācārya's house.

233 Śacīdevī came and offered Him her obeisance, and for seven days He took His meals from her.

234 Taking her permission, He set out again, and He humbly bade the devotees farewell:

235 “I shall go to Nīlācala with two companions. Come and meet Me at the time of the Ratha-yātrā.”

236 With two companions — Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya and Dāmodara Paṇḍita — the Lord came to Nīlācala.

237 After staying there a few days He set out for Vṛndāvana, leaving secretly at night without anyone knowing.

238 Only Balabhadra Bhaṭṭācārya stayed with Him. By the forest road of Jhārikhaṇḍa He came to Kāśī, enjoying many wonderful pastimes on the way.

239 After staying four days in Kāśī He went to Vṛndāvana; having seen Mathurā, He visited the twelve forests.

240 Seeing the places of the pastimes, He became overwhelmed with love, and Balabhadra led Him away from Mathurā.

241 Taking Him along the road beside the Gaṅgā, Balabhadra came to Prayāga, and there Śrī Rūpa came and met the Lord.

242 Rūpa fell to the ground in obeisance, and the Lord embraced him in supreme joy.

243 Having instructed Śrī Rūpa, He sent him to Vṛndāvana, and He Himself came to Vārāṇasī.

244 In Kāśī Sanātana came and met the Lord, who stayed two months and instructed him.

245 He sent him to Mathurā, investing him with the strength of *bhakti*; then, after showing mercy to the *sannyāsī*, He went to Nīlācala.

246 For six years the Lord enjoyed such pastimes, sometimes wandering here and there, sometimes living in the Kṣetra (Purī).

247 With the devotees He always enjoyed *kīrtana* in bliss, beheld Jagannātha and sported in love.

248 Thus I have given the *sūtras* (summary) of the Madhya-līlā. Now, O devotees, hear the *sūtras* of the Antya-līlā.

249 After He returned from Vṛndāvana to Nīlācala, He lived there eighteen years and went nowhere else.

250 Every year the devotees of Gauḍa came there and stayed four months in the Lord's company.

251 Constantly He sang and danced in the joy of *kīrtana*, and revealed loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*) to all, even to the *caṇḍālas*.

252 Gadādhara Paṇḍita Gosāñi lived in Nīlācala, and so did Vakreśvara, Dāmodara, Śaṅkara and Haridāsa,

253 Jagadānanda, Bhavānanda, Govinda, Kāśīśvara, Paramānanda Purī and Svarūpa Dāmodara.

254 Rāmānanda Rāya and the other residents of the Kṣetra all remained constantly with the Lord.

255–256 Advaita, Nityānanda, Mukunda, Śrīvāsa, Vidyānidhi, Vāsudeva, Murāri and all His other servants came together every year and stayed four months, and with them the Lord enjoyed many kinds of pastimes.

257 Haridāsa's attainment of perfection — all of it was wonderful; Mahāprabhu Himself held a great festival in his honor.

258 Then Rūpa Gosāñi came again, and the Lord infused His power into his heart.

259 Then the Lord punished Choṭa Haridāsa, and Dāmodara Paṇḍita "punished" the Lord with words.

260 Then Sanātana Gosāñi came again, and in the month of Jyaiṣṭha the Lord tested him.

261 Pleased with him, the Lord sent him to Vṛndāvana. Then came the Lord's wonderful meal from Advaita's own hand.

262 After consulting Nityānanda in private, He sent Him to Gauḍa to preach *prema*.

263 Then Vallabha Bhaṭṭa met the Lord, and the Lord explained to him the meaning of Kṛṣṇa's name.

264 Telling Pradyumna Miśra of Rāmānanda's qualities, the Lord had him hear talks about Kṛṣṇa from Rāmānanda.

265 Gopīnātha Paṭṭanāyaka, Rāmānanda's brother, was about to be put to death by the king, and the Lord became his savior.

266 For fear of Rāmacandra Purī He cut down His meals, but seeing the Vaiṣṇavas' sorrow He kept to half.

267 Within the universe are fourteen worlds, and all the living beings who dwell in those fourteen worlds

268 assumed human form and came to Nīlācala in the guise of pilgrims to see the Lord.

269 One day Śrīvāsa and all the other devotees held *kīrtana*, singing of Mahāprabhu's qualities.

270 Hearing this, the Lord spoke to the devotees in angry words: “Leaving aside Kṛṣṇa's names and qualities, what are you singing in your *kīrtana*?

271 All of you have set your minds on insolence; acting independently, you will ruin the world!”

272 At that very time millions upon millions of people on all sides raised a tumult, crying, “Glory to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya!

273 Glory, glory to Mahāprabhu, the son of the king of Vraja! O Lord, You have descended to deliver the world.

274 We have come from very far away in great distress. O Lord, grant us Your sight and fulfill our lives!”

275 Hearing the people's humble plea, the merciful Lord's heart melted; He came outside and let them see Him.

276 Raising His arms, the Lord said, “Say ‘Hari! Hari!’” — and the sound of Śrī Hari's name arose, filling all four directions.

277 Seeing the Lord, the people were filled with love and joy; calling Him God, they offered Him praise.

278 Hearing their praise, Śrīnivāsa said to the Lord: “At home You stay hidden — why reveal Yourself outside?

279 Who taught these people? What are they saying? Cover all their mouths with Your own hand!

280 It is as if the sun, having risen, wished to hide. We cannot understand such behavior of Yours.”

281 The Lord said: “Śrīnivāsa, stop this mockery. All of you together heap humiliation on Me.”

282 Saying this, He bestowed His auspicious glance on the people and went inside, and the people's desire was fulfilled.

283 Raghunātha Dāsa went to Nityānanda and there held the festival of flat rice and yogurt.

284 With Nityānanda's permission he went to the Lord's feet, and the Lord entrusted him to Svarūpa's care.

285 He made Brahmānanda Bhāratī give up his garment of deerskin. In this way He enjoyed His pastimes for six years.

286 Thus I have told the *sūtras* of the Madhya-līlā. Now hear the account of the last twelve years.

287 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, always hoping for their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the Caitanya-caritāmṛta.